



# Sports

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## No. 1,000 Wilkins reaches mark as Hawks stop Cavs

ATLANTA (AP) — For most of the game, Lenny Wilkins stood in his usual pose: arms folded, face stoic, not even a hint of the emotions that must have been churning inside.

Finally, though, it bubbled to the surface. First a slight grin. Then a broad smile. And finally, a hand-shaking procession with the fans who ringed the court.

"Lenny, Lenny, Lenny," they chanted.

Wilkins, already the winningest coach in NBA history, reached another milestone Friday night by getting his 1,000th victory as the Atlanta Hawks defeated the Cleveland Cavaliers 74-68.

The Cavs played without starting guard Terrell Brandon and Bobby Phillips, who were both hurt in Thursday night's win over Milwaukee. Brandon bruised his tailbone while Phillips severely bruised the side of his left knee and lower leg.

Precautionary X-rays of Phillips' leg were negative, but his leg was placed in a cast. Both players were to be re-examined today at the Cleveland Clinic and were listed as doubtful for Sunday's home game against Toronto.

Naturally, the win was satisfying for Wilkins, who coached the

Cavs from 1986-88 and had a record of 316-258.

"It's just incredible," Wilkins said after being doused with confetti at the horn. "It puts you on a plateau and nobody else is there. A lot of people are in triple figures, but not quadruple figures. I'm really happy."

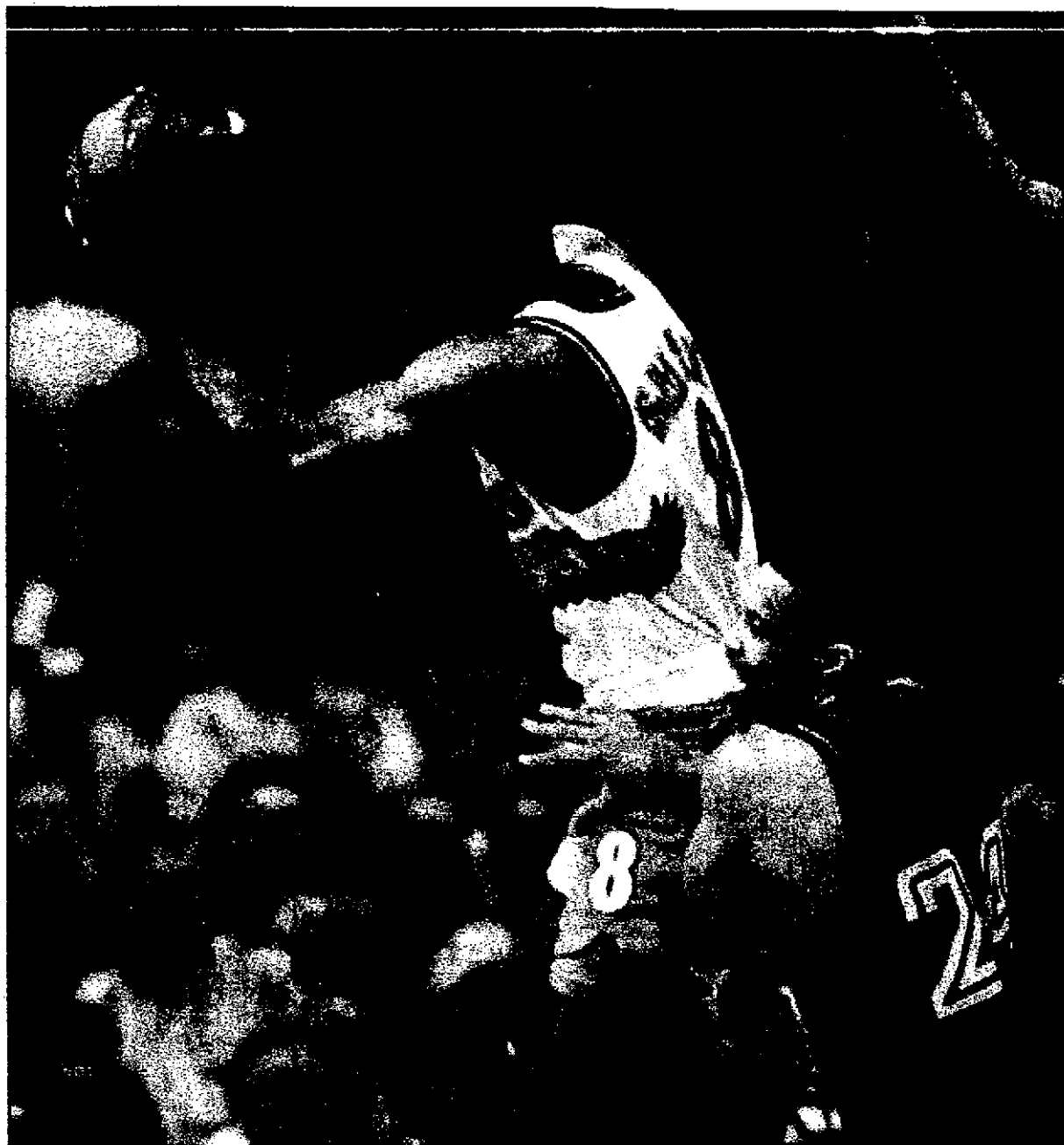
Of course, he didn't show that happiness until Craig Ehlo hit a 3-pointer with 42.1 seconds remaining to give Atlanta a 71-62 lead. The soft-spoken Wilkins isn't one to dwell on personal achievements, especially when there was still a game to be won.

"We earned No. 1,000," said Wilkins, who now has a coaching record of 1,000-838 in his 23-year career. "It was a struggle. Cleveland did all it could."

In the waning seconds, cheerleaders handed out placards which showed Wilkins' face inside a heart, accompanied by the words "Sweet 1000." When the horn sounded, Hawks general manager Pete Babcock came out to present Wilkins with the game ball.

As Wilkins was heading off to the locker room, a fan yelled, "Hey, Lenny, we want to shake your hand." Wilkins obliged,

See CAVS, C3



REBOUND MAN: Atlanta's Steve Smith grabs a rebound in front the Cavs' Chris Mills.

## Yanks stop Tribe

TAMPA, Fla. (AP) — Albert Belle hit a two-run homer in his first at-bat of the spring, but the Yankees rallied to beat the Cleveland Indians 5-2 Friday in the opener of Legends Field, New York's new spring training home.

Belle was fined \$50,000 Thursday by acting commissioner Bud Selig for a profane tirade at reporters prior to Game 3 of the World Series.

Belle homered in first on a 3-2 pitch from David Cone, a hanging slider.

"I wish I could have that hanging slider to Albert back," Cone said. "Other than that one pitch, I was happy."

Cleveland starter Orel Hershisser only one hit in two innings, throwing 18 strike in 26 pitches. His last two batters, Bernie Williams and Derek Jeter, were called out on strikes.

"I just wanted to get some work in on my fastball," Hershisser said. "I wanted to try and get it on both sides of the plate. I try to have a low pitch total because I try to go strike one. If you go strike one, you get the bat going and you get outs early in the count."

See INDIANS, C3

## Showdown is set Firelands, Falls advance to district tournament

Roger Negin  
The Chronicle-Telegram

LORAIN — It took Nick Thornsbury a half to warm up to the atmosphere at Lorain Admiral King's Shot Palace, but the taunts of the Trinity fans made Mike Collier feel right at home.

"Yeah, I heard them," said Collier after he and Thornsbury led fourth-seeded Firelands to a 65-48 victory over Trinity in a Division II sectional final game Friday night. "Everywhere I go they call me Pretty Boy. I'm used to it; I'm taking it as a compliment."

Collier had 30 points and eight steals as the Falcons advanced to the district semifinals Wednesday against top-seeded Olmsted Falls, a 61-46 winner over Cleveland Rhodes in Friday's second game.

"They have a heckuva team," said Thornsbury of Olmsted Falls. "We'll have to work on defense and rebounding against them."

Thornsbury struggled through a cold first half, then came out in the third quarter and sank 13 points, nine on 3-point shots, in eight minutes. He finished with 22, all but four in the second half.

"I finally hit the shots," said the 6-foot-1 senior, playing at Admiral King for the first time. "It was dark around the baskets and it did take awhile to get used to it. Both teams were off in the beginning."

Firelands led just 43-39 after three quarters, but broke the game open with a 22-point fourth, including a 9-1 spurt to start the period. The Falcons, 16-5, finished it off with an 11-4 run in the last 2:53.

"We were a little tight in the beginning," said Firelands coach Mike Horne. "We made an adjustment at halftime. We used a little more pick-and-roll and cleared out to get our shooters open. It worked. We also needed to make a few extra passes before we shot."

Trinity got 21 points inside from Terhan Freeman, a muscular 6-1 senior, and 15 outside from Mike Prucha, but nobody else contributed much.

The Firelands' inside game produced no baskets as B.J.

"Everywhere I go they call me Pretty Boy. I'm used to it; I'm taking it as a compliment."

Firelands' Mike Collier on the taunts from opposing fans

Solomon, Jason Sapienza and Josh Tansey were blanked from the field, but Anthony Allsop came off the bench to score nine big points.

Falls wins 19th

Olmsted Falls survived a rebounding onslaught by Rhodes to raise its record to 19-2.

"A win is a win," said Falls coach Pat Donahue. "At this point the goal is to win and continue to play."

Rhodes had a whopping 61-37 rebound advantage over the taller Bulldogs, including 35 offensive rebounds. The Rams had 20 second-chance points, but their offense dried up in the fourth quarter.

"Their big guys are a load," Donahue said of Rhodes' 6-4 posts Robert Lewis and Eddie Robinson, who combined for 26 of the Rams' points. "They give you big trouble on the boards. When they slash to the basket, it's tough to get a body on them."

Falls also was hurt when 6-8 junior Tim Schaefer picked up three fouls in the first half and spent time on the bench.

"We need Tim on the floor," Donahue said. "He's the Player of the Year in our conference and one of the best juniors in the state. But other kids stepped up."

Rhodes cut the lead to 46-43 moments into the fourth quarter, then Tim Matus hit a 3-pointer to spark a 10-0 run. Falls, leading 56-44, went into a four-corners offense and stalled out most of last 4½ minutes.

It's going to be a different game against Firelands.

"It sure will," Donahue said. "They play a little different style with Thornsbury and Collier. Firelands has a nice team; we'll have our hands full with them."

See FALCONS, C5



EXCUSE ME: Oberlin's Kevin Hobbs, right, tries to get away from Manchester's Adam Suszli in a 130-pound match. Suszli won 17-2.

## EC sends four wrestlers to semifinals Panthers land in third place after first day of action

Steve Byrne  
The Chronicle-Telegram

### DIVISION III

ELYRIA — The host school can be proud of getting four wrestlers into the semifinal round of the Division III district tournament, but fans might be talking about the one that got away.

Elyria Catholic will see Scott Burnett (112 pounds), Ed Cecil (119), Steve Brush (145) and Frank Gant (heavyweight) in the semis today (starting time, noon), but one of the Panthers' favorites, 125-pound John Dunstan, will go when the consolation matches begin at 10:30 a.m.

Dunstan entered the tournament as a sectional champion and owner of a 31-1 record. He was ahead of Manchester's Chad Armstrong 8-1 in the second period of their quarterfinal

match, but looked the other way just long enough to get put on his back and pinned.

"John's a tough kid," coach John McNulty said. "I know he's disappointed, but he'll be ready to go (today)."

Dunstan will face Isaiah Shipman of Cardinal Armstrong's first-round victim, in a consolation match today.

"It was like a fighter winning every round, then getting knocked out in the 15th by a haymaker," McNulty said. "John relaxed and got caught in a headlock. I'd rather it happen here than happen next week (at the state finals in Fairborn)."

Had Dunstan prevailed, the Panthers would have had the largest contingent in the semi-

inals. EC, Chanel, Independence, Manchester and Streetsboro all have four alive.

"I'm not so concerned about the team situation," McNulty added. "I'm just trying to get as many wrestlers out of here (and to the state tournament) as I can. John's match was just a fluke."

EC, ranked third in the state, is third in the team standings with 29 points. Chanel, ranked seventh and runnerup to the Panthers at the Brooklyn Sectional, leads with 36. Waynedale has 35 points.

Burnett ran his record to 31-0 by whipping Josh Kelling of Northwestern 20-5 and Dan Gilchrist of Mogadore 10-4. Cecil pinned Chris Formanek of Aurora in 1:43 and nipped Northwestern's Corey Firebaugh 4-3.

Brush, whom Ohio Wrestling Forecast predicts will be the Division III state champion, beat Jason Imhoff of Mapleton 18-1 and Jim Bragg of Woodridge 15-3. Gant nipped just 42 seconds to pin Robert Horodyski of Pymatuning Valley then toppled Waynedale's Kevin McGlone 11-3.

Other area wrestlers in the semifinals are Matt Grav of Columbia (112), James Schuster of Oberlin (125) and Jamie Adkins of Wellington (140).

Gray pinned Adam Calvin of Manchester in 3:53, then dispatched Damon Sams of Harvey 15-0. Schuster beat Wickliffe's Terry Smith 13-4 and Mogadore's Damen Drayer 18-4. Adkins won by default over Josh Orzechowski and downed

See PANTHERS, C6